

The great thing of a global strategic partnership is that you may have agreement on four things and disagree on one. You move forward on the four and then deal with the contentious issue. Even in a marriage you don't agree on everything.

Q. But will the US press India to sign the CTBT?

A. We have our challenges on CTBT; we haven't seen a treaty ratified in the US Senate for a while. The US President has made it a priority but he knows that a lot of work is required on it in the US and also with other countries. But the timing and political nature of this in India is something the Indian Government will determine.

Q. Post-26/11, has our cooperation on counter-terrorism expanded?

A. We are working closely on information sharing, better technical training and forensic capabilities. We have had many opportunities to share information with India which was not done earlier. There has been unprecedented cooperation against terrorism.

Q. Will you extradite David Headley and T. H. Rana to India?

A. I don't know if India has made that request so far, but we want to work very closely with India. We want to share actionable intelligence.

Q. But could you prevent a big ter-

rastructure of the LET and they need to do more about Hafiz Saeed. The US is doing a great deal recently and will continue to do so.

Q. But shouldn't you bind them in timelines to take action?

A. Timelines are less effective than action and results. Pakistan needs to concentrate on its internal threat of terrorism that is coming home to roost. We have said it in the 9/11 Commission, of which I was a member, that Pakistan is

Q. But the trust deficit between India and US still remains large.

A. Every new day builds more trust, from the FBI cooperating in the Mumbai investigation to the civilian nuclear deal to the exchange of real-time actionable intelligence.

Q. The US still has several Indian organisations on the entities list—the blacklist that bans trade for high tech equipment. Why is that?

A. Don't look at the glass as half

“We are pushing hard to complete the nuclear deal. There are no fresh demands or surprises.”



empty. Look what we have achieved in nuclear deal, look at defence where we are helping to modernise Indian military. We will continue to work together to prune the entities regime.

Q. Do you think the US has missed out on India's defence market?

A. We should be given a fair shot. We want transparency and fair play. We think we have the best products in the world. We may have had some disappointment in the past, but recently we have had fruitful discussions at the highest level. Defence sales worth \$18 billion are now in the pipeline.

Q. India has major differences with the US over key climate change issues.

A. It is in India's interest and the world's that it grows at 10 per cent. There is nothing that we want to do to mitigate that growth. There are lots of ways for the US and India to work together on climate change, including energy efficient, clean technologies.

Q. Trade between India and the US has slowed down again.

A. We should look at an early conclusion of the bilateral investment promotion agreement. We want to work on a whole range of opportunities in the infrastructure sector. I would end by saying that overall the partnership between India and the US is waiting to explode on the track of historic destiny.

“The timely arrest of Headley and Rana saved India and the US from another 9/11 or 26/11.”

ror attack following their arrest?

A. The good news is that Headley and Rana were caught and that India and the US proactively shared intelligence on this case and it didn't turn into another 9/11 or 26/11. The bad news is that these people have managed to establish base in the US.

Q. But there is a perception here that despite all the cooperation, the US doesn't put enough pressure on Pakistan. What more can you do?

A. We will be pushing Pakistan harder in three specific areas. We want Pakistan to prosecute seven terrorists involved in the Mumbai attack. They need to do more to dismantle the

the epicentre of terrorist groups and we need to work with the Pakistan government to concentrate on this threat.

Q. The US now seems to be going all out to please China. Where is India placed vis-à-vis China?

A. I don't think that we use one country against the other. The president of the US has decided that Manmohan Singh will be his first state dinner guest. That says a lot. It is not China, it is not the UK, not Germany. We want China to rise in a peaceful and non-threatening way that can work towards global prosperity. For the US today, India is the most important strategic relationship.

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